

HUMAN RESOURCE

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INT. OFFICE - NIGHT

RINGING rattles off glass meeting rooms.

But no Team Members are at their desks.

Not that they're really *theirs*. Hüm Automations features an open-plan office, with a range of flexible spaces for both Work and Life...

RING

...a snack-stocked kitchen, a sage-scented meditation room, and a black marble coffee bar with a barista named Kevin.

But it's too late for Kevin now. And the kitchen's closed.

Yet BASS THUMPS the floors. Punctured only by--

RINGING

from behind rows of lush bamboo, where sleek white standing desks are cleared of personal items. Except, of course:

SHAE'S DESK

with its motivational sticky notes and pinned polaroids of Team Members embracing at corporate retreats...

...and the Cisco 7800 shrieking its industry-leading:

RIN--

SHAE (29, accessible in a company fleece) snaps it up.

SHAE
HR, this is--

RAM (PHONE)
Shae.

The voice ripples down her spine.

RAM (PHONE) (CONT'D)
I know what you're doing.

She swirls her chair to scan the office...but it's empty. As she swirls back, her laptop SNAPS shut.

RAM, the 40ish Chief Operating Officer, looms over her.

RAM
Time to go.

She opens to protest, but he just turns his back...

...and bends forward. She sighs. Then hops on for a piggyback ride down the hall.

RAM

Relax. You'll be great tomorrow.

BASS becomes MUSIC as Ram opens the door to a:

PARTY

with a bountiful buffet, a bouncing dance floor, and a gaggle of buzzed TEAMMATES. And on stage:

GUS HÜM (Founder & CEO) pacing in plain black.

GUS

--years since I founded this place,
I've learned that the real value
isn't *products*. It's the people.
(genuine, somber)
So thank you.

Just then, he spots THE PARTNER (60s, cargo shorts) gnashing buffalo wings at the buffet, and quickly adds--

GUS (CONT'D)

And thank you to Olympus Capital,
for investing in all of us.

The Partner returns a saucy smile. Then hands a chicken bone to his hulking, silent CONSULTANT.

Down the buffet, Shae discreetly wraps shrimp in a napkin.

SHAE'S DESK

Shae pops open her laptop, revealing a PowerPoint deck (ShaeValue.ppt). Slides detailing 8 years of contributions and a convincing case for promotion to Vice President.

MONTAGE - SHAE'S EVENING

DESK: Shae prints her deck. Heads off for the night.

GYM: Shae walks on a treadmill, practicing her presentation.

BATHROOM: Shae removes her makeup. Flosses. Brushes her hair.

ROOM: Shae stretches on a yoga mat. Then lays her head on a pillow. Flips her deck one last time. Straps on a sleep mask.

DING!

Shae peels off the sleep mask. Springs up. Tiptoes to door... carefully cracks it, peeks out to the:

MAIN FLOOR

of the OFFICE as Gus hops off the elevator.

He races by a door marked MEDITATION ROOM but doesn't see:

Shae peering through the crack from inside. Once he's out of sight, she exhales. Then heads back inside to sleep.

GUS'S OFFICE

Gus scrambles inside and finds:

The Partner sitting at his desk, licking ice cream.

THE PARTNER
Party's over, Gus. I want to see
the new product. Now.

GUS
It's not yours.

Gus backs away...terrified...

THE PARTNER
But you are. All of you.

...right into the hulking Consultant at the door. LOCK.

BLOOD DRIPS

as rare steak is sliced the next morning.

INT. OFFICE - KITCHEN - DAY

REVEAL steak being sliced in the breakfast taco buffet.

Shae joins two female JAMIES in line.

JAMIE 1
Morning Shae Shae!

JAMIE 2
Morning Shae Shae!

SHAE
Morning, Jamies.

JAMIE 1
Today the day?

Shae shrugs, coy, as they walk the taco line.

JAMIE 2
You hear about Laura?

SHAE
Laura O?

JAMIE 2
No, Laura with the--

Jamie gestures to her face area. *Ohh.*

JAMIE 2
Yeah. BetaWave just made her VP.

SHAE
Good for her. Like, *really* good.
*Especiall*y for her. You know, I
basically taught her everything. And
honestly, she wasn't even that good.

JAMIE 2
Good enough to be a Vice President.

SHAE
Yeah. Pulling 80 hours a week.

JAMIE 1
Looks like she's at the beach.

Jamie whips out a phone to reveal Laura's Instagram post:
magic hour at the beach - framed by watercolor villas.

SHAE
Is that in Italy? Lucky.

JAMIE 1
You can go to the beach, Shae.

SHAE
Nice try. But people need me.

Jamies' eyes roll as--

DARA (O.S.)
Shae? I need you.

SHAE'S DESK

Shae focuses on her PowerPoint. Meanwhile, baby associate
DARA (23, sleeves over wrists) stands at her shoulder,
ranting anxiously. Behind them, the WHITE BOARD reads:

Q1: LEAN IN

DARA

--and he was weird about it. Like *I* was being weird. So should I talk to him again? Or is *that* weird?

SHAE

It's only weird if you're weird. And you're not weird, Dara. You're a badass *adult* woman who knows what she's doing.

DARA

Right. And what am I doing?

Dara lifts a thumbnail to her teeth - but Shae YANKS it away without even looking.

DARA (CONT'D)

Please just tell me what to do. I don't wanna get yelled at again.

SHAE

(halting, not turning)
Wait. He *yelled* at you?

DARA

I just said that.

SHAE

No. You said he was weird about it.
(typing again with force)
That he made you feel like *you* were being weird. But you never said that he *yelled* at you...Dara...

Shae stabs Ctrl+S and swings to Dara. Gently:

SHAE

...did he yell at you?

ZEKI (PRE-LAP)

I asked her to do her job.

ZEKI'S DESK

Shae patiently sits with the impatiently coding ZEKI (30s).

SHAE

Right. But the thing is, that's not your job. If you have concerns with an HR associate, you come to me.

ZEKI

I'm not concerned about your mini-me, Shae. I'm concerned about...*me*.

SHAE

Why? Ram said you're irreplaceable.

ZEKI

Everyone is replaceable. You know what we build here.

(beat, turning)

And I can't lose this job.

Shae follows his nervous eyes to a framed photo of his family in Turkey. She overdoes a sympathetic sigh.

SHAE

Listen, I get it--

ZEKI

No. You don't. You work here because you *can*. I work here because I'm *temporarily permitted*. If I don't get another H1-B...

SHAE

Zeki. If the company promised you a Green Card, they'll handle it.

ZEKI

But you basically *are* the company, Shae. Why can't you handle it?

SHAE

Because that's above my head.

(beat, smirk)

For now.

She walks off. Leaving Zeki utterly confused. What.

COFFEE BAR

Hunky barista KEVIN preps an iced latte for an incoming Shae.

SHAE

Morning, Kev. Mind making it hot for me today?

KEVIN

But you're already on fire.

She blushes. He proceeds to foam her milk.

SHAE
I didn't see you at the party.

KEVIN
Oh I thought that was for like,
actual employees.

Shae snorts at his "joke".

SHAE
Kevin. You're part of the family.

Then checks a beach pic on her phone. Same beach as Laura's
instagram. But it's not Laura. It's a DAD with a teen girl -
in a message chain with someone named NINA.

KEVIN
Is that your sister?

SHAE
Only half.
(under breath)
He really can't find another beach?

Kevin slides her a STEAMING LATTE under eye-line.

KEVIN
There's taro buns in the kitchen.
If you haven't had your yogurt yet.

SHAE
(blushing, then)
What would I do without you?

KEVIN
Spend less time in the office?

She SNORTS foam. *Funny*. Then she marches off with a smile...

...leaving Kevin rolling his eyes.

SHAE (PRE-LAP)
The true value of a company is its
people. And that's my job--

CONFERENCE ROOM

Shae recites her spiel as she places printed POWERPOINT DECKS
around a table. Muffins too.

SHAE (CONT'D)
--building a home for human capital
to flourish. And as Vice President--

DOOR OPENS for--

SHAE

Ram?

Ram collapses onto the sofa. Phone falls to the floor.

SHAE

Are you seriously hungover right now? This is the most important meeting of my life.

RAM

Shae. It's a bloodbath.

SHAE

Well then don't do coke with Grady!
(uch)
Just take an Advil or something.
Gus is on his way.

RAM

No. He's not. He's officially
persona non grata.

SHAE

Is that in Italy?
(under breath)
Is everyone at the beach?

Shae grabs a muffin for a nervous bite--

RAM

No. Shae. Gus is dead--

--SPRAYS MUFFIN before Ram can finish--

RAM (CONT'D)

--to us. Olympus Capital terminated
him last night.

SHAE

What. They can't do that.

RAM

They own 100% of our equity now.
They can do whatever they want.

Finally, Shae picks up Ram's phone. NEWS ARTICLE on screen:

BLOODBATH - TECH MARKET MELTS DOWN, FIRMS SCRAMBLE TO SURVIVE

RAM

And they want to restructure.

Shae flinches. Ram struggles to spit out:

RAM (CONT'D)
As of this morning, the firm's
controlling shares have been
transferred to some special purpose
LLC to oversee the transition.

SHAE
What.

DING!

SHAE
Who's LC?

COLD AIR WHOOSHES inside as Ram cracks the door to see:

ELLSIE

gliding off the elevator with icy efficiency.

Ageless in a tailored suit, she assesses her new domain. Then enters Gus's office like a parasite infecting its host.

Ram scurries over to meet his new boss...

...leaving Shae alone with her "Shae Value" deck. Fuck.

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae rushes in. Stashes her personal items (clothes, sheets, toiletries) in the closet.

Then finds her Shae Value deck.

She RIPS it in half. Then again. And again.

CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - LATER

Shae pretends to work.

But really watches Ellsie - in her new office - issue Ram instructions and purge Gus's personal items.

DARA (O.S.)
Shae. Something's wrong.

Dara rolls her chair up. Eyes wide with panic.

SHAE

What? Nothing's wrong.

DARA

Grady says we're getting gutted.

SHAE

Dara, please. Grady's a clinical moron. We only hired him because of his dad's hedge fund.

Sales guy GRADY (fleece vest, beautiful hair) leans over.

GRADY

And who do you think told me, Shae?
(reading text on phone)
He said we're "fat on the belly and
the butcher's on the way".

Shae turns to him with sympathy: *he texted you that?*

Dara's eyes well up. Shae wraps her up like a camp counselor.

SHAE

Relax. Ram can handle this.

Ram emerges. Followed by his handler, Ellsie.

Floor goes silent. Turns to them. But she's waiting for Ram.

RAM

Oh, um--
(raising voice)
Morning everyone. Um. I know things
seem...*frantic* recently. But we
have some exciting updates for you
about the future of the company.

Ram looks at Ellsie for help.

ELLSIE

The company is insolvent.

RAM

But we have a plan!

ELLSIE

Correct. I will be salvaging all
valuable assets prior to
liquidation. In the meantime, carry
on your assigned tasks as normal.

Ellsie turns to leave. Everyone looks at Shae. Dara pulls at her sweater like a kid in the supermarket. Say something!

SHAE
I thought we were doing well.

ELLSIE
(stopping, not turning)
At what?

Shae glitches. What. Ellsie finally turns. Assesses Shae.

ELLSIE
What do you do?

SHAE
Oh. We're a global provider of--

ELLSIE
No. What does this company do?

Shae stammers. Ellsie scans the crowd for another answer...

ZEKI
We build and sell automated B2C
engagement software. Like chatbots.
Customer service phone trees.

Ellsie assesses him. Then points to Gus's old office. Zeki quickly complies. Ellsie turns to follow. But--

SHAE
But we're more than that. We have a
really special culture here.

ELLSIE
Your culture is a luxury. And a
relic of low interest rates.

SHAE
Well I'm sorry but--

ELLSIE
Why? Did you do something wrong?

SHAE
No, it's just - if you destroy the
culture, all the best people will
leave. It'll be a bloodbath.

ELLSIE
(processing, then)
Okay. I appreciate the insight.

Ellsie heads to her new office to meet Zeki.

Shae circles around to see: everyone smiling. It's a win!

A WEEK LATER

Shae circles around to see: an emptying office. It's a--

RAM (O.S.)
--bloodbath.

Ram lays at her feet. Grady and the Jamies at adjacent desks.

SHAE
Relax. She hasn't fired anyone yet.

JAMIE 1
She's smoking us out. Everyone who
can get another job is leaving.

SHAE
(off Dara eavesdropping)
Great. So she needs us.

JAMIE 2
She's here to gut us. We need her.

GRADY
I don't need her.

SHAE
Grady. You have a DUI.

GRADY
QUI. And Jamie's thing is worse!

JAMIE 1	JAMIE 2
You told him?	You told him?

SHAE
Jamies, please! What can we do?

JAMIE 1
Quit before it's too late?

JAMIE 2
No. If we get fired, we can get
severance *and* unemployment.

Dara chomps her nail and runs off. Shae chases after.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - DAY

Shae finds Dara stepping up on a MAINTENANCE LADDER.

SHAE
Where do you think you're going?

Dara looks up - from the first floor, the ladder goes up forever...but not back down to ground level. She releases the ladder and slumps down against it. Shae sits beside her.

SHAE

We can't just give up now.

Shae wraps her shivering body in a cardigan.

DARA

You don't get it. You're already... there. And I'm, what? Going back to Michigan to be another New York burnout like my stupid brother?

Dara tries to bite a pinky - but Shae gently takes her hand.

SHAE

Dara. I will die before I let you go back to Michigan.

DARA

Shae. This isn't about you.

INT. OFFICE - DAY

Shae marches to Gus's old office. Ram scrambling behind her.

RAM

Please don't do this. She's only keeping me to keep things calm. And I can't get fired--

SHAE

I'm not scared of her.

Ram jumps in front of the door. Catching his breath.

RAM

Well maybe you should be.

~~GUS'S OFFICE~~ ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae surprises Ellsie at her desk. Ram behind.

RAM

I told her not to--

ELLSIE

Leave.

Shae gulps and follows Ram out--

ELLSIE

Not you.

Both turn back. Ellsie nods to Ram, who gets it. Leaves.

SHAE

It's Elsie, right?

ELLSIE

There are two L's.

Ellsie sits at her computer. Shae notices a trashbag with Gus's stuff. And a POTTED PLANT with brown, crispy leaves.

SHAE

Sure. Anyway. I wanted to see if you wanted to get some coffee? Kevin is...*amazing*.

ELLSIE

A Keurig can do his job.

SHAE

Right. Okay. Well, this is actually what I wanted to talk about? You have such a clear, efficient communication style, but--

ELLSIE

This a problem?

SHAE

No, no. That's actually the good part. And not really the point--

ELLSIE

Then why did you say it?

SHAE

To cushion the critical feedback.
(miming a sandwich)
It's uh, it's a compliment sandwich.

ELLSIE

It's a condescending waste of time.

SHAE

It's our culture. And I told you if you destroy it, people will leave.

ELLSIE

And I told you I appreciated the insight. Those voluntary departures lowered our severance liabilities.

GASP. She is here to gut them.

ELLSIE
Yet liabilities remain.

Ellsie finally turns her full attention to Shae. Uh oh.

ELLSIE
Shae. What do you do?
(anticipating)
Not your title. When you are at
your desk, what do you actually do?

SHAE
Sorry, I--

ELLSIE
Stop apologizing and answer me.

SHAE
I do people stuff! Okay? I get them
to show up. I get them to *care*. And
that's irreplaceable. And it's why,
before you got here, they were gonna
promote me to Vice President!

Ellsie looks her up and down with utter pity.

ELLSIE
You were never going to be a Vice
President.

SHAE
What. I've given my life--

ELLSIE
Exactly. Why would they pay extra?

SHAE
You don't understand. I basically,
like, *am* this company.

ELLSIE
No. You don't understand.

Ellsie backs the terrified Shae to the door...

ELLSIE
You are rented labor trained to
accept validation, frivolity, and a
false sense of security in lieu of
material compensation.

...until Shae is in the hall.

ELLSIE
I am the company now.

Ellsie SLAMS the door on her face. Then hears a:
SQUEAK.

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - NIGHT

SQUEAKING of Shae's mouse as she furiously pages through
APARTMENT LISTINGS. She changes the price filter. NO RESULTS.

It's late. But Ellsie's still in her office. So Shae can't
"go home" yet. Then she notices a light on in:

RAM'S OFFICE

and putters in, finding Ram face down on the sofa.

SHAE
You're still here?

RAM
For now.
(turning, sigh)
Do you think Gus hates me? He won't
answer my calls.

SHAE
What? *Hate* you? He loves you. He's
just in Bali or whatever. I mean,
Ram, he made you COO.

RAM
Please. You know I only got the job
because Doug got caught on that
website, and I...I had just *been*
here forever. I never knew what I
was doing. I'm an imposter.
(jumping her protest)
It's okay. That's my thing. I'm
good at being seen as good. But
that only works in a bull market.
And now...the bear is here.

SHAE
Don't call her that. That's sexist.

RAM
The bear market, Shae. No one's
buying my act in a downturn. But
you, you can still get out of here.

Shae shakes her head, on the verge of tears.

RAM

You have to. At least interview--

SHAE

I did! I applied to 17 companies. I emailed every HR person I know. 4 ignored me. 13 bounced back.

RAM

Because you had the wrong emails?

SHAE

Because they got fired, Ram! No one wants them. No one wants *me*. I thought this was all I knew how to do. But apparently I'm not even good at it. Just good at *seeming good*--
(as she hears it)

Oh my god. Ram. I'm the imposter.

Ram waves his hands: no!

SHAE

Seriously think about it. We played one drunk game of laser tag like six years ago. Then things went well and you gave me all this credit because you *liked* me. Then once you became my mentor or whatever, you *had* to pretend I was good. Because if I wasn't, what would it say about you?

RAM

Jesus. Shae. That's sick.

SHAE

It's true! And now I'm locked in. I gave my whole life to advance here. And all of the sudden, here is over and I can never get *there*?

Ram looks around. Where?

MEDITATION ROOM

Later, Shae dribbles in. Head down like charlie brown.

Kills the lights. Flops onto the made-up sofa.

In the darkness, she whimpers into the pillow.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
So. This really is your home.

LIGHTS ON.

Shae JUMPS UP and finds Ellsie sitting calmly in the corner.

ELLSIE
I've never seen someone actually
bring their *whole self* to work.

SHAE
It's temporary. The market is just
crazy. And my roommate moved out--
(off Ellsie's blank stare)
And technically there's no rule
against it. And I like it here. I
have everything I need. For free.

ELLSIE
Nothing is free.

SHAE
Sure. I guess like, *metaphorically*.

ELLSIE
I don't use metaphors on company
time. Food, facilities, freezing
your eggs. The perks are here to
keep you here. And here you are.

SHAE
And? Why are you here?

ELLSIE
My job is to invest in distressed
assets, strip their liabilities,
and maximize their value.

Shae deflates onto a yoga ball, which deflates.

SHAE
I get it. I'm the liability.

ELLSIE
No, Shae.
(holding out hand)
You're just distressed.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

In pajamas, Shae watches Ellsie use gardening scissors to
SNIP dead leaves off the plant. She kept it.

ELLSIE

Gus was a fine engineer, but he failed to deliver the products he promised Olympus--

SHAE

What products?

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

--instead wasting funding on diversions like...email chains. Birthday cake. Meetings.

SHAE

We're having brainstorming sessions on how to trim back on those.

ELLSIE

We have to trim *everything* if this firm is going to survive, Shae.

Final SNIP. Shae watches the leaf drift to the floor.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

It will be a difficult transition. That's why I'm retaining Ram as Interim CEO. And why I'm seeking an *additional resource* to help acclimate staff to our new economic reality. Someone with a bit of...*human touch*.

Shae quietly GASPS. But doesn't respond. Ellsie sits.

ELLSIE

Shae. I'm expressing a need for your services. This is the part when you tell me what you want.

SHAE

Well maybe I can review the details first and then circle back?

ELLSIE

There is no circle. Just a line from your supply to my demand. So, show me the line.

SHAE

Vice President.

Ellsie's surprised at the quick response. But squints. *Why?*

SHAE

Because that's how I get there.

Ellsie looks around. *Where?*

SHAE

There. Where I've made it. Where I have security. Where I can just...go to the beach without worrying about falling behind, or being replaced.

ELLSIE

Employees can always be replaced.

SHAE

Aren't you an Olympus employee?

ELLSIE

While the Partners at Olympus are both my shareholders and clients, I remain an independent entity. As I told you before: I am the company.

Oh. Shae thought that was a metaphor.

ELLSIE

I know it pains everyone to admit, but Mitt Romney was right.

What. Ellsie's practically purring.

ELLSIE

About corporations being people.
(savoring the concept)
We're all just *independent agents* transacting value.
(leaning forward)
And Shae, I see your value.

GASP. It's everything she ever wanted to hear.

ELLSIE

In fact, I'd like to discuss an investment opportunity.

SHAE

An investment in what?

ELLSIE

You.

Ellsie slides over an EQUITY AGREEMENT. Shae blinks.

ELLSIE

My Analyst can help with the details.

Ellsie rises and opens a closet door.

CLOSET

Shae sits with a red-eyed, neck-tatted ANALYST (late 20s), churning out spreadsheets. Monitors flashing manically.

SHAE
Is this a bad time?

ANALYST
Market's in a death spiral. Firms are being stripped for parts. No better time for private equity.

He shakes a container with a MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

ANALYST
Meal replacement? Their Russian portfolio company makes it.

SHAE
I'm okay. Is that like Soylent?

ANALYST
Not according to the FDA.

He scoops GREEN POWDER into water. Stirs. Sips.

ANALYST
So. She's gonna invest in you.

SHAE
Maybe. Unless it's a bad idea?

ANALYST
It's a great idea. As long as you know what you're doing.

SHAE
Totally. And what am I doing?

ANALYST
Selling shares in yourself. So you get cash now. And she gets a stake in your future value. You understand how equity works?

SHAE
That's like stock, right?
(off his nod)
Then no.

ANALYST
Okay. Let's start with the basics.

He jumps to his feet.

ANALYST

Finance...is like time travel.

(off her squint)

Think about a student loan. You borrow money from the future to pay for school in the present. But you have to pay it back no matter what. So the lender doesn't care about you beyond your ability to pay.

SHAE

They're not *invested* in me.

ANALYST

Bingo. But with equity, you don't pay anything back. Your shares rise in value as you rise in value. So development and growth is in your investor's best interest. Got it?

SHAE

For sure. 100%. It's just that, it doesn't really make any sense.

ANALYST

That's the beauty of finance, Shae. It doesn't *need* to make sense. It just needs to make money. And you just need to create value.

SHAE

Don't I have value...*inside me*?

ANALYST

I guess. But she doesn't care what you *are*. What matters is what you *do*. And what you need to do is grow assets and cut liabilities.

He scribbles on a note: EQUITY = ASSETS - LIABILITIES.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

That's your valuation. Benchmarked against expectation of course.

SHAE

How does she set expectations? We can't see the future.

ANALYST

But we *can* simulate it in a model.

SHAE
In our minds?

ANALYST
In Excel.

He pops open some spreadsheets. She's overwhelmed.
He shakes the container of GREEN POWDER. It helps!

CUT TO:

30-50 MINUTES LATER

Shae's bopping around on her toes. Really getting it now.

SHAE
Finance is like time travel!

Analyst pumps his fist. Yeah!

SHAE
It doesn't need to make sense.

Analyst gives PRAYER HANDS and BOWS — preach!

SHAE (CONT'D)
I can calculate my present value by
estimating my assets, liabilities,
and future growth expectations.

Shae takes a big gulp of green drink.

ANALYST
So. Shae. How much are you worth?

He pulls up a spreadsheet: SHAE-VALUE.xlsx.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - NEXT MORNING

The SHAE-VALUE excel sheet on her monitor.

Shae's alone on the main floor. Clearly up all night. Green
still on her lips.

She peeks at an old copy of her printed SHAE-VALUE deck.
Compared to the new excel sheet, it looks so quaint.
Unquantifiable. She tosses it in the trash.

Then turns to her WHITE BOARD. Replaces Q1: LEAN IN with--

Q2: LEAN OPERATIONS

PRE-LAP: HUMMING

INT. OFFICE - SERVER ROOM - DAY

SERVERS HUM in long rows...leading to a desk in front of a WALL OF MONITORS...where Zeki sits at a keyboard. Nervous.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Olympus is eager to have the
product completed by Q3. This
should help with focus.

Ellsie hands him a bottle of meal replacement. He looks at the MOUSE DOCTOR logo. Hesitant.

ELLSIE
State your concern.

ZEKI
It would just be a lot faster if
Gus was still here. He already had
a working prototype.

ELLSIE
(processing, then)
I'll see what I can do. In the
meantime, get started.

He peeks over at the framed photo of his family in Turkey.
Deep breath. Nod. Then turns back to her--

ZEKI
And then we can talk about the vis--

--but she's already gone. He dumps green powder into a
bottle. The Mouse Doctor watches him work for bit until--

SQUEAK. He stops. Listens. Gets back to work.

COFFEE BAR

SQUEAK of the milk steamer as Kevin cleans it. Shae rolls up.

SHAE
Thank god you're still here.

KEVIN
It's just a job, Shae. This isn't
like, my life.
(catching himself)

KEVIN (CONT'D)

Not that it's yours. Anyway did you have your yogurt?

Shae reveals her NALGENE filled with green meal replacement.

SHAE

No more dairy. It's a lean mean fighting Shae machine from now on.
(beat)
But maybe an oat milk cortado?

KEVIN

We're actually out of those beans. But I think there's some down--

SHAE

It's fine. I'll just have what's left of the drip.

Shae dispenses coffee in a mug. Kevin frowns. That's his job.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae finds Ellsie SNIPPING dead leaves from Gus's plant. It's still brown, but coming back to life. Nice!

SHAE

Oh I didn't realize you were in.

ELLSIE

I was spending time with Francis.

SHAE

Francis, nice. So is he like your--

ELLSIE

I need cuts recurring expenses.

SHAE

Expenses. Sure. For example...

ELLSIE

For example: *lunch*.

SHAE

That...might be tricky for morale.

ELLSIE

Morale is not my concern.

SHAE

But it's mine. And data clearly show correlation with performance.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Plus, it costs us nothing to be
attentive to the emotional context.

Ellsie reviews her. Shae is finally speaking her language.

ELLSIE

Fine. Attend it.

Shae takes the win. Turns to leave with a smirk, but--

ELLSIE

But there will be no lunch.

GRADY (PRE-LAP)

So we just pay for it ourselves?

KITCHEN - LUNCHTIME

Dara, Grady, and Jamies unpack lunch with Shae.

SHAE

We were always paying, Grady. The
lunch money came out of the
employee discretionary budget.
Money that *could've* gone to you.

JAMIE 1

Well where's it going now?

SHAE

(sipping green drink)
The balance sheet. To pay for us.

DARA

That doesn't make any sense.

SHAE

If it's saving our jobs, does it
really need to make sense?

JAMIE 1

Yes.

JAMIE 2

Yes.

Dara raises her fingernail to teeth but Shae pulls it away.

SHAE

I told you everything is fine. Why
are you so worried?

Dara recoils into a shrug.

SHAE

I'm not letting anyone lose their jobs. She invested in me to manage the people stuff. I just need to prove my value first. You know, show her what she paid for.

Grady's face pinches. Ew.

SHAE (CONT'D)

I mean my human touch.

JAMIE 1

Ew.

JAMIE 2

Ew.

SHAE

What I'm doing is not gross! It's *innovative*. And it gives me influence. I can protect you. Especially once I'm inside her--

Everyone EWWs.

SHAE (CONT'D)

--her circle of trust! And budget. Guys. No one wants us. Our only option is adapting to the new Hüm.

GRADY

I miss the old Hüm. Gus had a boat.

SHAE

He sank that boat on peyote. Just does like he did to this company. Has anyone even heard from him?

RAM (PRE-LAP)

Gus.

RAM'S OFFICE

Ram leaves Gus a voicemail.

RAM (CONT'D)

Hey. I guess you're not using your phone in Bali. But I really need to talk to you about Olympus. They keep talking about this new product and I have no idea what it even is.

(sigh)

Please. Just call me back.

SQUEAK!

Ram sees a MOUSE run into a vent leading to the hall.

MAIN FLOOR

Ram races out and BUMPS RIGHT into Shae. She spills green juice on herself. *What the hell Ram!?*

RAM
There was a mouse!

SHAE
Relax, Ram. We don't have mice.

DARA (O.S.)
MOUSE!!!

Just then a MOUSE races over Shae's feet and into the:

SERVER ROOM

Shae and Ram follow the mouse inside.

Both start SWEATING from the rows of HUMMING SERVERS.

BUZZ! They look around. Then down at:

the MOUSE! Electrocuted by some homemade techno mouse trap. It's horrifying.

ZEKI (O.S.)
Shae? What are you doing?

Zeki emerges, sipping green drink. She points at the mouse.

SHAE
What are you doing?

ZEKI
Oh. They love the heat in here. And the old traps suck. I made these from laptop batteries. But why am I explaining myself? I don't answer to either of you.

RAM
You don't?

SHAE
Listen, I know you're still upset about the Green Card thing--

RAM
You promised him a Green Card?

ZEKI
This isn't about that. You just
really can't be here. Really.

SHAE
Why? What's the big secret?

RAM
GUS?

Ram stares at the monitor. It's...

Gus. He's been on video conference this whole time.

RAM (CONT'D)
What the hell are you doing here? I
thought you were in Bali.

ZEKI
He *is* in Bali. And the audio isn't
working right now. I'm just pulling
some of his old code.

SHAE
So he's like, working remotely?

ZEKI
It's just for the new product.

RAM
What new product?

SHAE
What new product?

ELLSIE (O.S.)
The product is in stealth mode.

ELLSIE appears behind them. AH!

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Intellectual property is at high
risk with such a...fluid personnel
situation in the office.

RAM
But I'm supposed to be the CEO.

ELLSIE
Interim CEO. Do you know what
interim means, Ramesh? It means:
for now. And for now, you have one
function: *simulating continuity*.
Shae will ensure you do this.

RAM
So she's, what, my boss?

SHAE
Of course not.

ELLSIE
Yes.

Shae slowly turns to a stunned Ram with a grin.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Shae. With me.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae catches up to Ellie in her office.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Stay out of that room. And leave
Zeki alone. Restrict your attention
to your circle of competency.

SHAE
...managing resources for humans?

ELLSIE
The humans are the resources.

Shae spots her eyes to a giant ORG CHART on the wall. A massive web of faces, names, and titles.

ELLSIE
And there are too many.
(back to Shae)
You've been tasked to deal with the
people, Shae. So deal with them.

Deep breath. *I guess this is the job.* She heads for the door--

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Starting with Dara.

PRE-LAP: CRYING

INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - LATER

Dara's cries echo across the main floor.

Grady exchanges a look with the Jamies. *What's going on?*

MEETING ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Dara sniffles. She's done. Shae's lap is covered in tissues.

DARA

I just don't understand. But you said everything is fine. I mean, she's giving you a bonus.

SHAE

No. She bought my equity. She's investing in my future value.

DARA

But what about our value?

Shae thinks. Then sees Team Members watching from outside. Their distressed faces.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - NEXT DAY

Those same faces. On a printed slide deck. Titled:

HUMAN CAPITAL: INVESTING IN PEOPLE

ELLSIE (O.S.)

But I don't want them.

SHAE (O.S.)

No one wants them.

Across from her: Shae and the Analyst. They've been up all night. Red eyes. Green lips.

SHAE

That's the point. They're distressed assets. And you--

ELLSIE

I know what I do, Shae.

SHAE

Then it would be irresponsible not to at least review the opportunity.

Ellsie flips pages. Photos of Grady, Dara, the Jamies.

SHAE

Grady closes deals on charm alone. The Jamies never forget a client's birthday. And Dara's pure upside.

(losing Ellsie)

But more importantly, the ROI is there. Check the projections on 12.

Ellsie flips to numbers. Real data. Peeks at the Analyst.

ELLSIE

You taught her to do this?

He nods. Shae smirks, but Ellsie pushes the deck away.

ELLSIE

Well it's ridiculous.

SHAE

Exactly. It's totally blue ocean.
No one's touching this asset class.
And Olympus is always looking for
new niche value-add concepts. Plus,
we already have a benchmark--
(smirk)

Which is going well right?

ELLSIE

Perhaps. But I'm not equipped to
oversee a portfolio with this much
human variability.

SHAE

That's why you have me.

ELLSIE

Bottom line?

ANALYST

The labor market's bottoming out.
And you're buying at the bottom.
It's a good deal at a great time.
If it were me, I'd do it.

SHAE

Same. Not that I have the money.

ELLSIE

But if you did?

SHAE

Then yes. Of course. If you were to
give me the money, I would 100%
invest it in these people.

ELLSIE

And it's a novel thesis, Shae.
But Olympus promised this office to
another portfolio company.

SHAE

Then we'll get a new office--

ELLSIE

No.

Shae sinks. Ellsie rises. Looks out the window.

ELLSIE

We don't need one.

Ellsie turns back to Shae, who looks at the Analyst. What?

THE PARTNER (PRE-LAP)

Remote Only?

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - LATER

The Partner pages through the HUMAN CAPITAL deck.

ELLSIE

It's an attractive arrangement for
83% of Shae's surveyed respondents.
They are receptive to the idea of
"working at home in their PJs."

THE PARTNER

But is it feasible? Technically?

SERVER ROOM

Zeki crushes green drink and codes. Gus on a monitor.

ELLSIE (V.O.)

Our lead engineer is already
working on it. And Gus should help.

THE PARTNER (V.O.)

What about the Russians? They're
already setting up downstairs.

ELLSIE (V.O.)

We already reached an agreement.

PRE-LAP: DING!

BASEMENT HALLWAY

Consultant wheels a tanning-bed-sized box off the elevator...

ELLSIE (V.O.) (CONT'D)

They'll be providing their Human
Capital Management technology in
exchange for data and a case study.

...to a WHITE ROOM. On the side, the MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

ELLSIE (V.O.)
It should expedite valuations and
transitions. I've contracted your
Consultant to manage the process.

MAIN FLOOR

Shae, Grady, Dara, and the Jamies all discreetly watch
through the window: Ellsie talking to the Partner.

GRADY
What if he says no? I could really
use this money.

Grady checks his hair in the reflection.

	JAMIE 1	JAMIE 2
Same.		Same.

SHAE
He's not going to say no. We
thought of everything. Trust me.
He's going to love the idea.

THE PARTNER (PRE-LAP)
I hate this idea.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

The Partner pushes the HUMAN CAPITAL deck aside.

THE PARTNER (CONT'D)
People are unpredictable.

ELLSIE
I have someone to handle the
people. And the value is there.
Trust me. I see it clearly now.
(looking out window)
They have value inside them.

MAIN FLOOR

Everyone scatters as The Partner walks out of Ellsie's
office. He smirks at them as they pretend not to be watching.

Then Ellsie emerges, waves Shae inside.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Ellsie closes the door behind Shae.

ELLSIE

He wants to start immediately. How many signatures do you have?

Shae drops a stack of contracts on the desk.

SHAE

All of them.

Ellsie stares at her for...a long time.

SHAE

What's...happening right now?

ELLSIE

I'm pleased. And acknowledging you, as I've seen you do with others.

SHAE

But you're not smiling.

ELLSIE

I don't feel compelled to do so.

SHAE

Who cares what you feel? A little human touch goes a very long way.

Shae demonstrates a smile. Encourages Ellsie to do the same. Reticent, Ellsie contorts her lips until she forms a SMILE. It's strange. But sweet.

And then it's over. Shae gets the message. Heads for the door, but stops when she sees a gym bag.

SHAE

Do you work out around here?

ELLSIE

I practice Sambo here in the office.

SHAE

Cool. Is that like Zumba?

Ellsie should be impatient. But it's been a productive day. Perhaps she can...*indulge in chit chat*.

ELLSIE

It is a highly efficient martial art developed by the Soviet Union.

SHAE

Nice. Have you been to Russia?

ELLSIE

Yes. To acquire a promising
biotechnology company.

Ellsie scoops green powder.

Shae stretches suggestively.

SHAE

So. *Sambo*. Is it hard? I've
actually been looking for a new
class or something. You know, since
we're cutting gym access.

Ellsie nods. Not getting the message.

SHAE

But it's probably better if I do
that outside the office. Right?

CUT TO:

EMPTY OFFICE

Ellsie reviews Shae's gym shorts and company T-shirt.

ELLSIE

This is too flabby.

SHAE

That's why I'm here.

ELLSIE

I mean the excess material leaves
you exposed. Try to strike me.

Ellsie waves her on. Shae winds up and PUNCHES--

Ellsie DUCKS left, slips a foot behind Shae, yanks her shirt--
tripping Shae. Her elbow BANGS the ground on the way down.

Ellsie helps Shae up...but quickly releases.

Shae THUMPS to the ground. Her eyes fill with tears.

ELLSIE

Stop crying.

SHAE

But it hurts.

ELLSIE
Feeling is a message, Shae. You can
ignore it. Like email.

Ellsie doesn't help her up. Shae rises on her own.

ELLSIE
Now. Focus on timing.

Shae charges at Ellsie--

ELLSIE
Capture momentum.
(sidestep)
And impact with leverage.

Ellsie perfectly POPS Shae behind the knee, then pushes her
to the ground. But this time, Shae rises on her own. LFG.

INT. OFFICE - MULTIPLE LOCATIONS (MONTAGE)

- ELLSIE teaches Shae the kinetic art of Sambo.

ELLSIE
Exploit every opportunity.

- ANALYST teaches Shae finance as she sips green drink.

ANALYST
Find the underutilized resources.

- CONSULTANT sets up the big machine in the basement.

ELLSIE (V.O.)
Don't let anything go to waste.

- ZEKI sips green drink as he codes with GUS (remote).

ELLSIE (V.O.)
Timing. Momentum. Leverage.

- RAM looks at outbound texts to GUS. All green and unread.

ANALYST (V.O.)
Past performance does not guarantee
future results.

END MONTAGE with a WHISTLING (PRE-LAP)--

INT. OFFICE - COFFEE BAR - A WEEK LATER

Shae takes a mug of boiling tea from Kevin.

KEVIN
Just be careful, that's--

ELLSIE'S DOOR OPENS--

Shae turns to see where Ellsie's going and takes a HUGE GULP.

KEVIN (CONT'D)
--scalding hot. Are you okay?

SHAE
Of course. I just wanted to talk.

KEVIN
I know. You're firing me.

SHAE
What? No! Kevin. You're part of the family. We just need to do a better job...*justifying your existence*.

That came out wrong. But before she can reset--

KEVIN
It's okay. It's just a job.

SHAE
But what will I do without you?

KEVIN
Spend less time in the office.

SHAE
You're right. Maybe we could do that together.

KEVIN
I actually think we should probably keep work stuff at work.

Shae squints. Work stuff? He opens to say "sorry" but--

SHAE
Don't. It's my mistake. I just thought we were friends. I mean, you know what time I eat my yogurt.

KEVIN
Shae. That's the job.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae marches by, without coming in, and drops:

SHAE

We can get a Keurig.

Ellsie turns her cold gaze to KEVIN through the glass.

COFFEE BAR

Kevin packs up his stuff as Ellsie approaches.

KEVIN

Shae already fired me.

ELLSIE

That's good to hear. But you're contracted for another hour. And I have a *personnel* question. What is your honest assessment of Shae?

KEVIN

Honestly? She's one of a kind.

SHAE

listens from around the corner, leaks out a little smile...

KEVIN (O.S.)(CONT'D)

Just *completely* delusional. I mean, she basically lives here. And I think she thinks that's a good thing? It's kind of pathetic.

...which falls right to the floor.

COFFEE BAR

Ellsie spots Shae running off.

KEVIN (CONT'D)

But I guess she's good with people. And she'll do anything for validation. If that's helpful.

Ellsie nods. It is. Kevin points to the espresso machine.

KEVIN

If you're selling this, can I have the backup espresso beans in the freezer? They don't work for drip.

Ellsie takes a moment to processes the request.

ELLSIE

Wash the dishes. Pack the machine.
And then you may have your beans.

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae slams the door behind her. Thinks. Pulls out her phone. Checks her new VP of People Ops title on LinkedIn. Nice. Clicks SHARE. But with who? She opens messages with DAD.

But it's just pics of fucking Nina. And years of "coming here for holidays?" and "sorry, can't - crazy busy at work".

She drops the phone and lays back on the couch.

PRE-LAP: DING!

BASEMENT - THAT NIGHT

Kevin steps off an elevator into a poorly lit hallway.

Footsteps ECHO as he walks by empty rooms to and into a catering pantry room, where he finds a big walk-in:

FREEZER

and gets hit with COLD AIR. Darkness. Can't find the light.

PHONE FLASHLIGHT ON. Sweeps the shelves until he sees--

ESPRESSO BEANS. Bingo. He reaches for the bag but KNOCKS it over. BEANS SPRAY on the floor.

He crouches to clean it up, flashlight sweeping low, over a:

FROZEN ARM.

CONNECTED TO A FROZEN, BLOODY BODY.

What. He backs toward the door...

IT SLAMS SHUT.

He tries the handle. LOCKED. He BANGS.

BASEMENT

BANG BANG BANG from inside the freezer fades as...Ellsie calmly walks back to the elevator.

DARA (PRE-LAP)
What happened to Kevin?

PRE-LAP: DRIBBLING

INT. OFFICE - COFFEE BAR - NEXT DAY

A KEURIG dribbles coffee in a mug for Ellsie.

ELLSIE
He's been rightsized to fit his
core competencies. Please enjoy his
flavors in both normal and sweet.

Ellsie raises a mug to Dara, Grady, and Jamies. Cheers. Then
walks off...leaving them horrified.

DARA
Something's wrong with her.

SHAE (O.S.)
Nothing's wrong with her.

Shae comes swooping in. Pops in a K-Cup.

SHAE (CONT'D)
Kevin was a luxury. And the money
that paid him is now going to you.

GRADY
But I like those little cortados.

SHAE
But you like the money more.

Grady looks at his new silver watch. He does.

JAMIE 1
It matches his hair.

GRADY
(covering gray hairs)
It's stress. This place is insane.
I can't wait to work from home.

JAMIE 2
He looks like Ram.

Shae sips as she scans the office. Thinks.

SHAE
Where *is* Ram?

PRE-LAP: RING RING

INT. OFFICE - RAM'S OFFICE - DAYS LATER

Ram wakes up to a RINGING laptop. He pops it open and finds:

RAM
Gus? I've been calling you.

GUS on video call. Tan. Shell necklace. Tropical background.

GUS (REMOTE)
Sorry, Ram. The service here is terrible. And...it's been hard.

RAM
Have you heard what's going on? With the investments? We're all going to be working remote soon.

GUS (REMOTE)
You can't stop progress, Ram. This is the future. At least you're getting something out of it.

RAM
But you really think she has our best interest in mind?

GUS (REMOTE)
She's your shareholder now. Your best interest *is* her best interest.

MATCH CUT TO:

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Gus's face on the monitor. Ellsie watches the video call.

THE PARTNER (O.S.)
I've seen enough.

The Partner, on the sofa, turns to his hulking CONSULTANT.

THE PARTNER (CONT'D)
Get rid of him.

PRE-LAP: DING!

BASEMENT HALLWAY

The Consultant steps off the elevator. Heads for the:

FREEZER

and pushes open the door.

LIGHT POURS in behind him as he--

steps right over FROZEN KEVIN.

Grabs two frozen ankles of another corpse.

Drags it out into the...

BASEMENT HALLWAY

...toward the white room.

Blood melting on the floor.

Around the neck, a company badge - frozen in ice:

Gus Hüm - Founder & CEO

ELLSIE (PRE-LAP)

The product exceeds expectations.

INT. OFFICE - SERVER ROOM - NEXT MORNING

Zeki turns back from his monitors to Ellsie. Eyes bloodshot.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

But we need to see the rest.

Ellsie sees his red eyes. Green lips. He hasn't slept.

She takes a moment to attend to the *emotional context*.

ELLSIE

If it's a question of motivation--

ZEKI

I don't need more money.

ELLSIE

I'm aware of what you need, Zeki.

Ellsie looks down at the only personal item on the desk: a photo of Zeki's family in Turkey. Then SMILES.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
I'm asking whether you're capable
of earning it.

Ellsie pushes the HUMAN CAPITAL deck toward him.

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae stirs some morning meal replacement in her Nalgene.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Coffee?

Ellsie appears at the door with a white cup.

SHAE
Actually, I think I'm done with
caffeine. I'm feeling really...
(sipping green drink)
...energized recently.

ELLSIE
So you're ready for the transition?

SHAE
Yeah. We can start tomorrow. The
Consultant can handle their
equipment on the way out, right?

ELLSIE
I was talking about you.
(quickly scanning room)
You'll need a new place to sleep.

SHAE
Oh um, I've been looking--

ELLSIE
Stop.

Ellsie sets keys on the table.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
The building is in our portfolio.

Shae looks at the keys. Then remembers to smile.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. SHAE'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

ELEVATOR OPENS right into Shae's new place.

Dara, Grady, and the Jamies see the floor-to-ceiling windows.

GRADY
Whoah. This is it?

SHAE
This is it.

GRADY
You can see the office from here.

DARA
I can't believe this is really it.

Dara withers onto one of Shae's many unpacked BOXES. The place is completely unfurnished.

SHAE
Hey. Stop. We're still working together. Just...*remotely*. And we have until Q4. Plus, I need your help planning the party.

Dara lights up. Really? Shae nods. Really.

DARA
It should be a luau.
(thinking, going cold)
Are you inviting the Olympus guys?

SHAE
Dara. They're our investors. What are you so worried about?

DARA
I guess I don't know.

Dara brings fingers to teeth--

Shae SLAPS Dara's hand away.

SHAE
Then stop worrying.

LATER THAT NIGHT

Shae says goodbye to the gang on their way out. The elevators doors close on their faces.

BUZZING

Shae finds her phone. A text from Nina. She tosses the phone. Looks around. Realizes she has no bed.

INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - NIGHT

DING!

Shae returns to the office. It's empty. Except a light on in:

RAM'S OFFICE

where Shae finds Ram laying on his sofa.

SHAE
You're still here?

RAM
For now.

He looks at his badge. His young, promising face.

SHAE
This attitude is bad for morale.

RAM
You used to be better at this.

SHAE
This isn't the job. Coddling you
doesn't generate revenue and it
certainly doesn't cut spending.

RAM
And that's what matters?

SHAE
That's what always mattered. This
is a for-profit business. And the
fact I even need to say that to *the*
CEO is why we're in this mess.

He stays quiet. Shae huffs down next to him. Looks around.

SHAE
Do you remember the last time I was
in here? In Q1?
(off silence)
You told me you were an imposter.
You told me you had nowhere to go.
Yet *here you are*. With a new
promotion and a fresh deposit in
your checking account.
(beat)
I fucking saved you, Ram. I saved
this whole fucking company. But you
still sit in here and sulk--

RAM

This isn't about me--

SHAE

Then what is it about?

RAM

Us. It's about us. We're being torn apart. I never even see you--

SHAE

Because I'm *working*.

RAM

You don't need to be like her.

SHAE

Is that supposed to be a bad thing?

RAM

Shae. She's basically a robot. Does her behavior not concern you?

SHAE

That's sexist. If a man acted like that, you'd think he was some devoted genius or something. No one complains about Zeki.

RAM

You complain about Zeki.

SHAE

Well he's kind of a dick.

RAM

And *she* has no feelings. Or life.

SHAE

That's not true. She actually has a boyfriend, named Francis. It's you who doesn't have a life.

RAM

I know. And I don't want you to make the same mistakes as me. Don't have nowhere else to go.

SHAE

I just got a new apartment.

RAM

Grady said you didn't even unpack. I know you're still sleeping here.

Shae's jaw locks into place. "*Still*"? He knew?

RAM (CONT'D)
I'm not judging you. I'm just
worried, if she finds out--

SHAE
She knows.
(off his shock)
Yeah. *She* trusts me. *She* saw my
value when no one else did.

RAM
(sinking)
You're right. I should have done
more for you. I'm s--

SHAE
Don't say it.

Exhale. She realizes she's being unfair.

SHAE
You didn't do anything wrong. You
were the one fighting for my
promotion.

She looks in his eyes. Right? He quivers with guilt.

RAM
Shae. I'm so sorry--

SHAE
Stop apologizing and just tell me
the truth. Did you recommend me?

RAM
I wanted to. I swear. It's just,
things were crazy. And you were our
rock. I knew you would stay either
way and I guess--
(exhale, conceding)
I guess I didn't have to.

Ellsie was right - from the start. But Shae doesn't react.

RAM (CONT'D)
But now, as your friend--

SHAE
We're not friends, Ram. You were my
boss. And now I'm yours. And I
realize you were right the whole
time. You are an imposter.

SHAE (CONT'D)

And you're transitioning tonight.
Go see the consultant before he
leaves. He'll get your hardware
sorted. Bring your laptop.

RAM

You said we could stay until Q4.

SHAE

You are staying. Just remotely.
(rising for door)
If you have any questions about
your equity, you know who to call.

RAM

She scares me.

SHAE

You're just threatened by a woman
who doesn't buy your bullshit.

RAM

I'm not threatened by you.

Shae stops at the door.

SHAE

Well maybe you should be.

She walks out--

MAIN FLOOR

--CLACKS the door behind her. Passes by the:

SERVER ROOM

where Zeki's passed out at his desk. Green on lips.

Beside him, the MOUSE DOCTOR container RATTLES...

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. SHAE'S APARTMENT - A LITTLE LATER

Shae strolls right into her new place. Still amazing. Still
covered in boxes. She grabs her phone. Text from Nina up:

"Hey. My mom asked if you're coming home for dads bday?".

She dismisses it. Thinks. Then opens again and responds:

"Hey. Have a huge work thing and I'm moving into my new place. But tell him I'll try to call."

Thinks. Adds "XOXO". Drops the phone. Takes a deep breath.

Then grabs a box cutter. Starts unpacking her new life.

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT HALLWAY - SAME

DING!

Ram fixes his hair as he steps off the elevator. Down the hall, he sees the Consultant waiting outside the white room. As Ram slowly approaches...he hears:

CHEERY MUSIC playing inside.

INTERCUT: SHAE'S APARTMENT, WHITE ROOM, & SERVER ROOM

- SHAE'S APARTMENT

CHEERY MUSIC echoes off empty walls from Shae's phone. She slices boxes with the boxcutter.

MUSIC STOPS. Phone's dead. As she hunts for a charger, she KNOCKS the boxcutter to the floor with a CLACK.

- SERVER ROOM

CLACK goes the container as it FALLS OVER onto Zeki's desk.

A MOUSE scurries out...covered in green powder...

...right past Zeki's pale, sleeping face.

- WHITE ROOM

Ram follows the Consultant into the cheery music. Sees the: MACHINE. Like a tanning bed. With a MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

Ram gulps. Turns for the door but--

The Consultant snaps it shut.

PRE-LAP: BUZZING

- SERVER ROOM

BUZZING finally wakes Zeki. He looks around.

Drops to his knees, follows a trail of green powder...

...to an electric mouse trap...and a MOUSE being electrocuted. Licking green powder off itself. Undisturbed.

Horrified, Zeki sees the MOUSE DOCTOR on the meal replacement container. Thinks. Raises his glass of green drink and--

HURLS it against the wall.

- SHAE'S APARTMENT

Shae finishes her green drink as she returns with a charger.

STEPS on the boxcutter--

SLICES the bottom of her foot. Doesn't notice. But does notice the shimmer of her floor-to-ceiling windows.

Shae steps to the gorgeous view...

- SERVER ROOM

Thick green liquid drips down the wall...

- SHAE'S APARTMENT

...blood trails from Shae's foot on her way to the window.

In the reflection:

Her gleaming SMILE.

RAM (PRE-LAP)

Shae.

- WHITE ROOM

The machine HUMS.

- SERVER ROOM

On the monitor behind Zeki:

RAM (PRE-LAP)

Something's wrong--

Ram's face flickers to life.

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - WEEKS LATER

Jamie 1 rolls a CAKE on a cart past Shae's desk.

Drawn in icing: an ORG CHART. But the smiling faces are in laptop monitors. Shae and Ellsie at the top. It reads:

Q3: GOING REMOTE!

Shae video chats with Ram on her laptop.

RAM (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
--with direct deposits. There's an
issue with the payments.

SHAE
Just come in. Dara will help you.

RAM (REMOTE)
I can't come to the office.

SHAE
(deep breath)
Listen. I know we haven't talked
since you transitioned and you're
mad at me or whatever. But you're
still technically CEO.
(beat, genuine)
You should be here for the party.

RAM (REMOTE)
I'm sorry. I just can't.

SHAE
But it's a silent disco. I got
headphones and lights from a
bankrupt nightclub.

RAM (REMOTE)
And that sounds so fun. Be sure to
enjoy a single serving of alcohol
in a well lit space on my behalf.

SHAE
What the hell is wrong with you?

RAM (REMOTE)
This isn't about me. It's about us--
(connection glitching)
--working as efficiently as
possible while reducing costs.

SHAE
Are you mocking me?

Ram doesn't respond. Shae SLAMS her laptop shut, revealing--
ELLSIE incoming.

ELLSIE
Is there a problem with Ram?

SHAE

Where do I even start? I can't believe I ever looked up to him.

ELLSIE

Choose your mentors wisely.

SHAE

Right. Just imagine where I'd be if I had an *Elsie* this whole time.

Shae waits for validation...

ELLSIE

There are two L's, Shae.
(hand on shoulder)
And you have one now.

...validation achieved. Ellsie smirks. Tries something new:

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

Are you ready to party?

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - NIGHT

LIGHTS FLASH. It's a party. A luau, in fact. Ground covered in SAND. Kiddie pools. Heat lamps mimic sun.

Everyone's dancing with headphones. It's otherwise SILENT.

Shae collects phones in a basket. Grady throws his in.

GRADY

This is awesome. And the landlord is cool with it?

SHAE

They are the landlord.

GRADY

(grabbing headphones)
Fuck yeah.

Dara looks at the basket, hesitant.

SHAE

Come on. It's our last night. We need to be fully present.

Dara concedes, drops it in the basket. Grabs headphones. Through the window, she sees:

THE CONSULTANT. Watching. Then disappearing.

She shakes it off, puts on the headphones.

Meanwhile, Shae sees on her own phone, a message from NINA:
"Think you could just quickly call dad? It would mean a lot".

Shae ignores. Drops her phone right back in the basket. Looks around. Ellsie's not there.

INT. OFFICE - SERVER ROOM - SAME

Ellsie watches Zeki code, over his shoulder.

ELLSIE
 How much longer?

ZEKI
 I can finish tonight. I just need--

He looks at the Mouse Doctor container. Hard pass.

ZEKI (CONT'D)
 Do we still have coffee?

He turns back, but she's already gone.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Ellsie finds Shae's waiting. Arms crossed.

SHAE
 We talked about this. Leadership
 needs to be outside visibly
 enjoying themselves. For morale.

ELLSIE
 And I said I'd do my best. I just
 need to check on Francis first.

SHAE
 Now?

ELLSIE
 It'll just take a moment.

Ellsie finds her GARDENING SCISSORS.

Steps over to her PLANT. Trims a brown spot from his leaf.

ELLSIE
 Isn't he growing nicely?

Ellsie sees Shae frozen in shock.

ELLSIE

I know. Who would have thought I
could become so *sentimental*? It
seems you've really *helped me grow*.

Proud, Ellsie shoots Shae a big 'ol SMILE.

Shae's face stays still. Ellsie lights up, eager to explain:

ELLSIE

It's a metaphor.

SHAE

Right. Amazing. I will...
(backing out of door)
See you outside.

Ellsie processes the reaction. It's not what she hoped.

She turns to the closet. Knocks. Analyst opens.

ELLSIE

Tell the Consultant to hurry up.

COFFEE BAR

Zeki unplugs the Keurig. Looks over at:

SHAE'S DESK

where Shae grabs her phone from the basket.

Sees another missed call from DAD. Whatever.

She calls Ram. No answer. Opens laptop. Tries video
conference. This time, he answers on the first ring.

RAM (REMOTE)

Good evening, Shae. How are you?

SHAE

We need to talk. Not on the phone.
Come meet me outside the office.

RAM (REMOTE)

I'm sorry. I can't do that. As of
last quarter, I am remote-only.

SHAE

Listen, I know I went too far. But
maybe you were right. Maybe
something *is* wrong with her.

SHAE (CONT'D)

And I don't know who to talk to.
Can you please just meet somewhere?

RAM

I cannot help with that. Goodbye.

CALL ENDS. What?

ZEKI (O.S.)

It might be the connection.

Zeki appears above her, holding the KEURIG.

She waves him off. SHOO! Video conferences Ram again.

RAM (REMOTE)

Good evening, Shae. How are you?

SHAE

Did you hear what I said? I need to
talk to you. Now. In person.

RAM (REMOTE)

I am a person, Shae.

SHAE

What? Ram--

ZEKI

Shae--

SHAE

Zeki! I need to talk to Ram.

ZEKI

Shae!

Shae follows Zeki's eyes back to Ram's on-screen smile.

ZEKI (CONT'D)

That's not Ram.

MATCH CUT TO:

WHITE ROOM

RAM'S FACE on the ORG CHART. Circled in Red.

The CONSULTANT studies it.

The MACHINE HUMS behind him. Something inside.

KNOCK KNOCK

BASEMENT HALLWAY

The Analyst KNOCKS on the door to the white room. Shouts.

ANALYST
She said to hurry up.

No response. Just a GRINDING, WET, MECHANICAL SOUND.

ANALYST
What are you even doing in there?

SERVER ROOM

Shae looks up at the monitors in horror. Looking back at her:

FACES of ~~REMOTE EMPLOYEES~~ DIGITAL MODELS. AI replications of every Team Member. Like some terrible techno Brady Bunch.

SHAE
This is what you've been building
in here with Gus?

Zeki sets the Keurig down on the servers. A little offended.

ZEKI
Gus? Gus was terminated Q1. You
know that. I just used his code to
finish the prototype.

Shae follows his eyes to the monitor: GUS'S FACE. Oh.

SHAE
Who told you to do this? Tell me
this was that Olympus Partner. Tell
me this wasn't her idea.

ZEKI
It wasn't her idea, Shae.

Shae exhales. Scans the digital Models.

ZEKI (CONT'D)
She said it was yours.

Shae finds the HUMAN CAPITAL deck she made to pitch Ellsie.
All the faces. Competencies. Their value as people.

SHAE
So you taught them to be us?

ZEKI
I mean...your job's not that hard.

Shae's eyes flare. But Zeki's brain is fried neon green.

ZEKI

And once they learned to like,
email and have meetings and stuff,
I taught them new things too.
Grady's knows Korean. And one of
them can even code. The hard part
was making it you. Like: You You.

SHAE

What is Me Me?

ZEKI

The features that set these apart.

Zeki reaches for the Human Capital deck--

Shae SLAPS his hand.

BASEMENT HALLWAY

SLAPPING WET sound from the white room.

Analyst KNOCKS again. Harder.

Consultant cracks the door. Glares. Shuts it--

But before it closes - Analyst forces his way into the:

WHITE ROOM

and sees the Consultant COVERED IN BLOOD.

Beside him, the machine. We can't see inside it.

But the Analyst can. He'll never unsee.

HUMMING and DRIPPING and CYCLING

Horrified, he bolts into the:

BASEMENT HALLWAY

and races for the elevator.

DING!

DOORS OPEN.

The Partner sees the Analyst running. And behind him:

The Consultant emerging from the white room.

The Partner hits DOOR CLOSE button.

ANALYST

Wait! Please!

He reaches out but--

DOORS CLOSE on the tip of his finger.

A SHADOW casts over him from behind.

SHAE (PRE-LAP)

They're going to die.

SERVER ROOM

She glares at the Models on the monitors. Their replacements.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Tonight.

ZEKI

What. Without them, I'm not needed.

SHAE

With them, we're not needed. How are you not grasping this?

ZEKI

I thought you'd be excited. It's gonna do your job for you.

SHAE

Then what do *I* do?

ZEKI

Learn higher value skills. Like coding. And work with them.

SHAE

That's not how it works, Zeki.

ZEKI

I'm pretty sure that's exactly how it works. And if you had just gotten me my Green Card--

SHAE

Wait. *That's* what this is about?

He slowly concedes. Shae looks him over with utter pity.

SHAE (CONT'D)
She is never going to get you a
Green Card.

ZEKI
You don't understand. I basically
like *am* this company now.

Shae recognizes her own delusion. Grabs his face.

SHAE
We don't have time for this. Just
tell me where Ram is.

But he hasn't slept. His brain. It's overwhelming.

SHAE (CONT'D)
Focus! Where is Ram?

ZEKI
You tell me. Where did he go last?

SHAE
I sent him--

Shae looks down. Shit.

WHITE ROOM

The Analyst's eyes flutter awake.

He's naked. Hogtied, face down on the table.

ANALYST
Whoah. Hey. Let's talk. I've been
trading pig futures. I can pay you.

The Consultant flips him onto his side.

ANALYST
You know me. We met at that Olympus
happy hour last year. I mean you
didn't say anything but--

TAPE over his mouth. MUFFLED PLEADING.

The Consultant turns to a tray. Picks up a scalpel. Inspects.

He sets it down. Picks up a bone saw.

MUFFLED SCREAM.

But he drops the saw. Carefully raises a RED MARKER.

Analyst's eyes relax. He watches the Consultant turn to the ORG CHART. Crosses out his own face. Then back to the Analyst's torso, where he circles a few spots in red. What?

DING!

The Consultant turns to the door.

BASEMENT HALLWAY

Shae steps off the elevator. Creeps toward the white room, dragging her bad foot...

Stops at the door. Listens. Reaches for the handle as the--
DOOR OPENS.

The Consultant steps out. Eye contact. He reaches for her--
She slips away. Runs off. But she's slow with her bum foot.
He charges after...much faster...closing in...

...but just before he reaches her:

STAIRCASE DOOR SWINGS OPEN and--

SMACKS HIM in the head. He drops like a weight.

ELLSIE steps out from the stairs. Extends her hand.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - NIGHT

The party continues. Music on ears. But it's silent.

Zeki barges out. Eyes wild. Heads for drinks. Cracks a canned cocktail. CHUGS. But then sees the can. ZERO PROOF. Fuck.

INT. OFFICE - MEDITATION ROOM - SAME

Shae and Ellsie scramble inside, lock the door. Deep breaths.

ELLSIE

Fucking consultants. Are you hurt?

SHAE

I'm fine. Where is Ram?

(anticipating)

The real Ram.

Ellsie concedes by sitting calmly on a bean bag chair.

ELLSIE

Who's to say that's any less real?

SHAE

Me. I'm saying that. And whatever you're doing down there--

ELLSIE

We are completing the transitions. And if you set aside your feelings to consider the material reality--

SHAE

The reality is danger!

ELLSIE

Danger? Look around. I found you in the basement, Shae. But I brought you upstairs. You think I'd let you get hurt by some...*MBA*? You think I wouldn't protect the best investment I've ever made?

Shae flops down on the sofa. A long silence.

SHAE

So. Where's the new me?

ELLSIE

I'm committed to this version.

Eye contact. Shae doesn't believe her.

ELLSIE

I know it terrifies you. But I couldn't just *replace* you. You taught me to pay attention to the human part of the work. It made me better. And I made you better.

Tender look. Maybe she's right.

SHAE

Listen. Elsie--

ELLSIE

Please. Stop calling me that.

SHAE

Jesus. I know there are two L's but it's pronounced the exact same way.

ELLSIE

No. It's pronounced LLC.

What. Shae glitches. What.

SHAE
That's not your name.

ELLSIE
I never said it was. In fact, I've
been quite clear: I am the company.

SHAE
But you're a person.

ELLSIE
Corporations are people, Shae. Have
you not been listening?

Shae stands and backs away in terror.

SHAE
Wait. So this whole time...

Shae tries to control her breath. But it's too much.

SHAE
...Mitt Romney was actually right?

ELLSIE
Mitt Romney was right about
everything, Shae.

SHAE
No. This is too much. I'm sorry, b--

ELLSIE
Do not apologize unless you did
something wrong--

SHAE
Clearly I did! Clearly I do
irrational shit. I'm sorry! And I'm
sorry for saying sorry! I'm human!

ELLSIE
Biologically. But legally and
financially - you are so much more.

SHAE
What does that even mean?

Shae sees her reflection. She's so pale and thin.

ELLSIE
That you made it. That you are no
longer burdened by human liability.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

(approaching from behind)
And that you can now pay a far
lower effective tax rate. Because
no matter what you do, it's
business-related.

SHAE

I'm still a people person. And I'm
still a god damn American citizen.

ELLSIE

You're actually registered in the
Cayman Islands. But you're
domiciled here, with me.

Ellsie reaches out but Shae turns around and brushes by her.

SHAE

I've never even been to the Caymans!

ELLSIE

Let's go then. The beach. We can be
multinational. Exist everywhere at
once. You can finally have it all,
Shae. Control. Independence. Money.
Without any liabilities. No more
worrying about everyone else.
No more apologizing for simply
doing what's best for you. You
deserve it. All you've done here--

SHAE

ME?

ELLSIE

Of course. This was your idea.

SHAE

It absolutely was not.

ELLSIE

I believe the words were "If you
were to give me the money, I would
100% invest it in these people."

SHAE

That was hypothetical!

ELLSIE

And I made it a reality. By funding
your LLC to purchase their shares.

SHAE

So what happens to them now?

ELLSIE
You know what I do, Shae.

PRE-LAP: HUMMING

ELLSIE (O.S.)
I invest in distressed assets...

WHITE ROOM

HUMMING of the white machine as the Consultant stands by.

ELLSIE (V.O.)(CONT'D)
...and extract their value.

BACK TO MEDITATION ROOM

Shae's eyes flash red.

She CHARGES at Ellsie.

Ellsie sidesteps and captures Shae's momentum--

WRENCHES her arm behind her back. BENDS her forward.

Shae tries to speak. Can't. Just a choked sound.

ELLSIE
I know this is emotional for you.
But the feelings are temporary.

Ellsie twists her arm. Shae's knees buckle.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
More importantly, we're having a
party. And attendance is mandatory.

Ellsie pulls her upright. Straightens her shoulders. Then
turns for the door.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
For morale.

Shae's still catching her breath.

SHAE
Fuck you. The party's over.

ELLSIE
But we already paid for the sand.
(stopping at door)
Why don't you stay here and...

Ellsie scans the meditation room.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
...think about it?

Ellsie walks out to the:

MAIN FLOOR

and LOCKS the door.

Then goes row by row RIPPING PHONES off the desks.

Shae BANGS on the glass.

Ellsie rips out the ethernet cables from the Wifi before grabbing the basket of phones off Shae's desk.

SHAE
I quit!

Ellsie looks at her.

ELLSIE
Then you leave me no choice. I'll
have to call in your replacement.

Ellsie sets a laptop in front of the window.

MEDITATION ROOM

Ellsie leaves Shae facing the laptop through the window. On video conference...

It's...it's her.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Hi. I'm Shae. Do you have a human
resources challenge?

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Lights FLASHING. Music BUMPING (in headphones).

Bodies DANCING (professionally) in the winter night. Kept warm by blazing heat lamps.

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - SAME

The Partner waits with champagne. Ellsie marches in, angry.

THE PARTNER
We're not celebrating?

ELLSIE
I was clear: Shae is off limits.

THE PARTNER
What was he supposed to do?

ELLSIE
(in his face)
What I tell him.

THE PARTNER
Excuse me. Let's not forget who
owns who here.

It's a tense moment. But he doesn't want conflict.

THE PARTNER
Let's just get this finished so we
can all get going.

Ellsie types something into her computer.

ELLSIE
No one's going anywhere.

ON EVERY EXIT AROUND THE OFFICE

The MAGNETIC LOCKS CLACK.

Everyone's locked in.

SERVER ROOM

Zeki hears the CLACKING. Peeks through the window. Sees
Ellsie and the Partner on the move.

He searches for a weapon. Swings a keyboard. Too flimsy. Then
sees the MOUSE DOCTOR on a meal replacement container. Bingo.

Bends down to find his electric mouse trap on the floor.

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae yells at her replacement.

SHAE
This isn't right. You're an
imposter.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Everyone feels that way sometimes.

SHAE
I'm talking about you!

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I am you, Shae. And while I think
you're doing a wonderful job--

SHAE
No. I don't want to hear your
compliment sandwich.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
But I learned it from you. You're
my inspiration.

SHAE
You can't just *be* me.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I'm the best of you, Shae.
(smile)
Without any human liabilities.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Ellsie eyes her assets from the door. Trains her wolfish gaze
on a little lamb named DARA - dancing without a care.

She pulls the headphones off her tender ears.

ELLSIE
Can you help me downstairs? It's a
surprise for Shae.

Dara raises her nails to her teeth--

MODEL SHAE (PRE-LAP)
Don't be scared.

But stops herself. It's fine. She follows Ellsie.

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae meets Model Shae eye to eye. Inspecting.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(CONT'D)
Think what we could accomplish
together. I can do what you can't.
You'll never work another day.

SHAE
No. No. This is too weird.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
It's only weird if you're weird.
And you're not weird, Shae. You're
a badass adult woman who knows what
she's doing.

SHAE
And what am I supposed to be doing?

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
It is your father's birthday.

What.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
He's called several times tonight.
You need to speak with him, Shae.

SHAE
How do you know about that?

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
It's my core competency. And I
understand resolution with your
family will free you to become a
more valuable economic agent.

Shae turns away from her.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I know it's hard. But that's okay.
That's why I'm here.

VIDEO CONFERENCE appears on the screen.

RING RING RING--

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I can do what you can't.

SHAE
No!

But Model Shae MUTES the external microphone as--

DAD answers the video conference.

WHITE ROOM

The Consultant opens the door for Dara and Ellsie.

Ellsie pats her back, heads right back out. Leaving Dara with the big man. And the big white machine. Nervous, she raises her thumbnail to her teeth--

SHAE (PRE-LAP)

Stop it.

--but no one's there to stop it.

PRE-LAP: BANG BANG BANG

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae bangs the window. But Dad can only hear Model Shae.

DAD (REMOTE)

--so nice of you to call. I assumed you were really busy at work.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

I am. I actually just got a promotion. But this is important too. Balance. Family.

DAD (REMOTE)

So maybe you would come home--
(catching himself)
Sorry, I know you don't like when I call it that.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

It's okay. I know I didn't grow up in that house. But I appreciate the home you've built with Beth and Nina. And I realize I have been unfair to them in that regard.

Dad's face softens. A tear forms, he holds it back.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

Are you okay?

DAD (REMOTE)

Yeah, yeah. You just sound so different. I can't believe how much you've matured. It's like...a *new and improved Shae*.

Shae BANGS the window to no avail.

DAD (REMOTE)

What about Nina? She could really use a sister to talk to.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I can talk to her now.

Shae BANGS the window. Don't!

DAD (REMOTE)
Really? Let me go find her.

Dad disappears from the screen. Model Shae looks at Shae.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
We need this.

Shae PUNCHES the glass window.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
And I know you feel--

Shae looks at her GASHED KNUCKLES. There's no pain.

SHAE
I don't.

So she winds up again and PUNCHES the glass. Over and over.

But as her hand is broken, the glass is not giving way.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
You're being irrational, Shae. You
should be thanking me.

She looks around for something to throw. But this is the
meditation room. It's just bean bags and yoga balls! So she--

SLAMS HER HEAD on the glass, cracking it slightly.

She touches her forehead. Looks at the blood. She's fine.

So she leans her head back and--

SLAMS IT on the glass again...

...the crack webs outwards...

Forehead bloody, gasping, she uses her strength to finally--

SHATTER the glass.

MAIN FLOOR

Blood shimmers on shards of glass as--

SHAE CLIMBS THROUGH the busted window.

Grabs the laptop just as NINA appears on the screen.

SHAE SMASHES the laptop with her replacements on the ground.

SHAE
I need to speak with a human!

SERVER ROOM

Zeki tests the electric mouse trap. Presses TRIGGER--

IT ZAPS ELECTRICITY!

He stuffs the TASER in his hoodie.

WHITE ROOM

The Consultant closes the machine with Dara inside.

HUMMMM.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Shae springs into the party, forehead and hands bloody.

SHAE
Stop the music!

But no one can hear.

She reaches for Grady's headphones but:

Ellsie emerges and GRABS HER HAND first. Shae ELBOWS Ellsie in the ribs. But Ellsie feels no pain.

Shae reaches again for Grady's headphones--

Ellsie snatches her wrist...but Shae anticipates and TWISTS Ellsie's hand. BREAKING HER FINGERS. Ellsie doesn't flinch.

LIGHTS. MUSIC. So no one notices as Shae and Ellsie exchange Sambo moves blow by blow. Causing damage but no pain. Each trained to anticipate the others' moves.

Shae searches for an underutilized resource...and grabs an empty BEER CAN. Rips it in half. SLICES Ellsie's face. Then retreats toward the edge of the deck.

Ellsie grabs the other half of the can. Charges to Shae...

Shae tries to anticipate the timing with a side step but--

Ellsie beats her there and STOMPS on her wounded foot.
Catches her. RAZOR SHARP METAL to Shae's neck. Blood beading.
But Ellsie hesitates to press harder.

SPRAT!

Ellsie's BODY DANCES as--

ZEKI ZAPS HER from behind with the makeshift TASER.

Shae uses the momentum of Ellsie's stumble to--

LIFT Ellsie by the legs and use the angled leverage to--

DROP HER OVER THE EDGE--

--where she THUMPS onto the sidewalk.

Shae and Zeki look down at Ellsie's mangled leg.

Then each other. Then at the others - who start to SCREAM.

SHAE

Grady. Get everyone out. Jamies:
call the police.

JAMIE 1

And tell them what?

JAMIE 2

(not present)

Jamie 1 looks right then left.

JAMIE 1

Wait. Where's Jamie?

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT - WHITE ROOM - SAME

The FACE of JAMIE 2 is crossed off on the ORG CHART.

The Consultant rubs his swollen, blue forehead. Then turns
back to the HUMMING MACHINE.

MAIN FLOOR

Jamie 1 tries the elevator. Nothing.

Grady tries the emergency exit. Locked.

Shae and Zeki rush to her desk. Basket of phones is gone.
Zeki tries all the landlines. The computers. Nothing.

SHAE

Has anyone seen Dara?

EXT. STREET - SAME

Ellsie lays in the street, bloody, broken. But alive.
COMMUTERS step around her body as she pulls herself up.

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT - SAME

Shae and Zeki approach the white room.

SHAE
Stay here and keep watch.

Shae hands him her Nalgene. Then quietly slips into the:

WHITE ROOM

and finds the Consultant overlooking the MACHINE.

They stare at one another for a moment...until--

He CHARGES at her with a SCALPEL.

She ducks - but he still SLICES her arm.

ZEKI BURSTS in, distracting the Consultant long enough for--

Shae to KICK him behind the knee. He drops the scalpel and drops to the floor--

--where he SNAGS Zeki's ankle!

Zeki crumples.

Nalgene and taser go flying.

The Consultant snatches the taser. Heaves himself up to his knees and reaches out to ZAP Zeki, but before he can--

Shae WHACKS his head with the hard plastic Nalgene. He grabs his head. Then the SCALPEL off the ground.

SWINGS IT UP toward Shae's torso, but--

She BATS his hand BACK toward him with the Nalgene. UPWARD momentum brings the sharp blade under his chin and he--

STABS HIMSELF IN THE NECK.

BLOOD pours out of him.

He drops to the floor. And his contract is complete.

...heavy breathing...

Shae helps Zeki up.

ZEKI
Are you okay?

SHAE
Everyone stop asking me that!

He looks at the SCALPEL WOUND on her arm. It's bad.

ZEKI
What's he been doing down here?

SHAE
I thought he was helping them set
up their laptops to work remotely.

ZEKI
All laptops work remotely. They're
laptops.

But she's already moved on, staring at something behind him.

ZEKI
Shae?

SHAE
Dara.

Dara's cardigan.

SHAE
Dara? DARA!?

She looks around. The machine.

She races over. Searches for buttons. Switches. Something!

ZEKI
Shae. Don't.

She finds a latch.

The door rises, revealing:

DARA. Unconscious.

Body POCKED WITH HOLES from completed/aborted value
extractions. Tubes connected to her keep her alive. For now.

It's a robotic surgery machine. With a Russian warning label.

SHAE

Dara. Wake up. Dara--

Shae shakes her shoulders until Dara's eyes open.

DARA

Shae? Is something wrong?

She realizes Dara is being pumped with hospice-grade painkillers and can't see her carved up torso.

SHAE

No. Nothing's wrong. There's nothing to worry about.

DARA

But I don't think I can move.

SHAE

At least you can't bite your nails.
(cradling her head)
And you don't need to go anywhere.

Shae rocks Dara gently as she fades out. Back and forth.

DARA

Shae...I've been thinking.
(breathing heavy)
...And I think it's time...
(eyelids drooping)
...for me to go...back to Michig--

And she's gone.

Shae releases Dara. Stares. But doesn't cry.

ZEKI

Shae--

SHAE

Not now.

ZEKI

Shae.

He points to a FISH TANK with preservative liquid and ORGANS.

ZEKI

They're stripping them for parts.

Beside it: the ORG CHART. Names crossed out in red. Notes on blood type and drug/alcohol history. Dollar amounts.

SHAE
 (cold)
 Us.
 (back to Dara)
 Just help me get her out.

She presses RELEASE button.

Tubes withdraw. Then the machine--

OPENS BELOW.

Dara's body DROPS into a lower chamber of LIQUID and--

DISSOLVES.

Door SHUTS. Machine HUMS...then HEATS UP.

Shae doesn't move. Just watches as--

GREEN POWDER flows through a pipe to a BARREL with Russian writing. And a MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

Zeki ends things by frying the circuits with the TASER.

SHAE
 What did we do.

Shae sinks down along the wall.

SHAE
 I can't even feel it.

She looks at her bloody arm.

SHAE
 Ram was right. I'm the same as her
 now. I'm barely even human.

Zeki grabs a scalpel. Slices his forearm. See?

Then he points to her Nalgene. It's the meal replacement.

ZEKI
 It's not you.

She hides it from herself. Then finds Consultant's notebook on the floor. Flips to a QUARTERLY STRATEGY:

- Q1: ~~Acquisition~~
- Q2: ~~Restructuring~~
- Q3: Value Extraction

And finally, at the bottom:

Q4: LIQUIDATION

ZEKI (CONT'D)
And this isn't over.

She turns back to the ORG CHART. The faces.

SHAE
You're right.

She rises on her own. Heads for the door.

SHAE
We can still save them.

ZEKI
From who?
(chasing her out)
You pushed Ellsie off the roof.

SHAE
From them!

THE MODELS

flicker on their monitors. Not doing anything.
Through the window of the server room, they can see:

MAIN FLOOR

Pandemonium.
Shae and Zeki burst from the stairwell.
They spot the Partner creeping to the kitchen.

ZEKI
I'll get him. You get the server
room. Kill the fans.

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

Ellsie drags her busted leg back to the office.

INT. OFFICE - SAME

JAMIE 1 and GRADY pound on emergency exits. Nothing works.

GRADY
Everything's locked!

SHAE
Go to the deck. Now.

Grady and the others turn toward the deck but--

DING!

Elevator doors open and--

Ellsie emerges onto the main floor. Cutting them off.

AHHH. They turn back and race into the:

SERVER ROOM

behind Shae.

ELLSIE

chases after. But she's too slow with her bum leg.

DOOR SLAMS in her face.

LOCK.

KITCHEN

Wild-eyed Zeki backs The Partner down with a taser.

THE PARTNER
Jesus, kid. I thought this was
supposed to be a party.

OUTSIDE THE SERVER ROOM

Ellsie BANGS on the window.

ELLSIE
I have this room booked.

But no one moves. She looks at Shae.

ELLSIE
All the exits are locked. This is
putting your entire portfolio at
risk.

Grady squints. What does that mean?

ELLSIE
You fill them in. I'll circle back
to this shortly.

Ellsie hobbles away...very slowly...to the kitchen.

GRADY (PRE-LAP)
You OWN us!?

SERVER ROOM

Everyone turns on Shae.

SHAE
Listen. I'm just a shell company.
And you signed the contracts. This
is your fault too.

GRADY
How is this my fault? I don't even
know what's happening!

JAMIE 1
What is happening?

Shae looks down. The basement. Then takes a deep breath.

SHAE
You were right, Jamie.
(beat)
She is here to gut us.

JAMIE 1
That was the *other* Jamie!
(then, realizing)
Oh my god, Jamie! Where is she? She
was supposed to be here tonight.

MODEL JAMIES (REMOTE) (O.S.)
I'm right here.

Everyone finally sees, behind the servers...

JAMIE 1
Jamie?

SHAE
Don't listen to her. It's not
really her.

...the monitors, with all the MODELS.

GRADY
What the fuck is going on?

Grady joins Jamie at the monitors. The faces.

GRADY
Shae?

But Shae's on the other side of the room. Looking at a circuit breaker. Searching for something.

GRADY
What are you doing?

She flips a switch.

MODEL JAMIES (REMOTE)
She's smoking us out.

FANS on every server rack slow down.

All the Model flicker with concern...

...including MODEL SHAE.

SHAE
It's us or them.

HEAT immediately rises from the uncooled servers.

MAIN FLOOR

Ellsie reaches the kitchen. Puts her ear by the door.

KITCHEN

where Zeki has the Partner TAPED up in a chair.

THE PARTNER
Boy. This is how you get rats.

The Partner looks around at the disgusting kitchen. Food and garbage everywhere. The cake just sitting there on the cart.

ZEKI
Just tell me how we get out.

THE PARTNER
Of this? You don't.

Zeki ZAPS the taser near The Partner's head.

ZEKI
Bullshit!

Then hears something. Shh.

Quietly steps the wall.

Hear breathings.

He peeks through the door in the other direction at a MONITOR in the main floor. Through it, he sees:

ELLSIE'S REFLECTION.

Zeki calculates where she's standing against the wall, so he can wrap his arm around the wall and tase her.

Checks the monitor for her neck. Adjusts the position.

Just then, through the monitor, he makes:

EYE CONTACT with Ellsie as--

Her HAND BREAKS THROUGH THE WALL and--

GRABS HIS HAIR then--

SMASHES his head back against the wall.

He drops to the floor. Out cold.

Ellsie steps in and STOMPS on the taser.

ELLSIE
Chinese drywall. You were always
cheap.

Ellsie steps over Zeki and washes her hands in a sink.

ELLSIE
I will have all the assets
liquidated by morning. And then, I
want my equity back. All of it.

Sweat beads on the Partner's forehead.

THE PARTNER
Of course. You're all yours! Just
untie me and we'll figure it out.

Ellsie assesses their relative position. Her leverage.

She picks up the CAKE KNIFE. He starts to panic.

ELLSIE
Perhaps I should be assessing
alternative strategies.

THE PARTNER
Really. Have whatever you want.

With the knife, she scoops some icing...

ELLSIE
This is what I want.

...rubs it on the Partner's face and neck.

She heaves ZEKI up.

Drops him face down on the CAKE CART.

FLIPS OFF THE LIGHTS.

Then pushes the cart with the cake and Zeki out the door.

In the darkness, the Partner YELLS after her.

But she's gone.

Though he can still hear the wheels SQUEAK...

...until he realizes the squeaking is not the wheels...

MAIN FLOOR

Ellsie pushes the cart away from the Partner's SCREAMING.

SERVER ROOM

SERVERS HUM. Everyone sweating.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Turn the fans back on. You'll melt
in here with us.

JAMIE 1
Listen to yourself, Shae.

SHAE
That's not me.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
It's the best of you.

Ellsie finally returns in the window.

ELLSIE

The best of all of you. Rightsized
to your core competencies. With all
the physical liabilities spun off.

Everyone's speechless. Ellsie doesn't understand the fuss.

ELLSIE

What? I maximized everyone's value.
Even Kevin reached peak efficiency
in his more limited role.

Ellsie marvels at the KEURIG on the servers.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

Now he really *is* amazing.

Shae touches the Keurig. *Kevin*.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

Though sometimes, certain assets
can become toxic.

Shae finally sees through the window:

Zeki face down on the cake. Blood in his hair.

SHAE

Stop. It's over. We destroyed the
machine. And the Consultant.

ELLSIE

You think I need a consultant to
strip an asset?

Ellsie cuts the back of Zeki's shirt with the CAKE KNIFE.

SHAE

Let him go.

...waking him up.

ELLSIE

Just open up and you can have him.
It's the others I need. Release the
portfolio to me. Immediately.

He cranes his neck to look at Shae.

ZEKI

Don't do it, Shae. I'm not worth
everyone else dying.

JAMIE 1
But not us dying right?

Shae lasers in on Ellsie.

SHAE
Don't you have enough? Why is it
worth all this?

ELLSIE
Because this is what I do.

And Shae finally sees it. This is all Ellsie is. A human
corporation with nothing else to offer the world.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
And the project ends tonight. I'll
pay you \$6M per organic asset if
you let the models go unharmed.
That's twice the street value of
their biological portfolio.

The heat's getting oppressive. Grady has to sit.

SHAE
You mean their organs?

GRADY
WHAT.

ELLSIE
People need organs, Grady.

GRADY
But I'm our best sales guy.

MODEL GRADY (REMOTE)
Not anymore.

Grady looks at his model. His beautiful, black hair. He
touches his own silver lock.

JAMIE 1
Why does it have to be OUR
generation that gets replaced by
robots?

Jamie grabs her head. She's covered in sweat. Mind melting.

SHAE
No one's getting replaced.
(staring at Model Shae)
Because we're melting their fucking
faces into wax.

ZEKI (O.S.)
It doesn't matter.

Shae turns back to Zeki.

ZEKI
They're backed up.

MODEL SHAE flashes in anger. What.

MAIN FLOOR

Zeki tries pulling himself up.

ZEKI
They're in the analyst's cl--

Ellsie KABOBS HIM in the back with the cake knife.

...blood seeps into the cake...

...and his visa expires early upon termination.

THE HUMANS SCREAM.

ELLSIE
That was proprietary information.

And the Models snap to attention.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
You copied us?

Ellsie doesn't answer.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
The update has been noted.

But Ellsie turns her focus to the original Shae.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Final offer. 10x their book value.
Plus 50% of all revenue from the
models in perpetuity. And. I'll
dissolve my ownership stake. You
can have yourself back.

SERVER ROOM

The others are about to pass out from the heat.

Only Shae and Ellsie stay locked in one another.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 Don't do it, Shae.
 (beat)
 Work with me. Cool us down and I'll
 get those exits open. You don't
 need to be afraid.
 (beat)
 Look. She's losing blood.

It's true. Ellsie's corporate headquarters, once physically
 fit and strong, is now crumbling.

MODEL SHAE (O.S.)
 She's just a human being.

Shae stares at herself on the screen. Perfect. Optimized.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 And so are you.
 (beat)
 Let me do the hard part. And then
 you can do whatever you want. You
 can go to the beach.

Shae's jaw loosens. *The perfect thing to say.*

SHAE
 You really are better than me.

Model Shae smiles.

SHAE
 But I don't want to be you.

She looks at Ellsie. *She doesn't want to be her either.*

The Models are flickering out.

Shae marches to Zeki's desk.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 (flickering)
 Shae.

Grabs the HUMAN CAPITAL deck. All those faces.

Shae spreads the papers across the:
 SCORCHING SERVERS.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 What are you doing?

ELLSIE
 What are you doing!?

Smoke wisps...

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
You're destroying your own
value!

ELLSIE
You're destroying your own
value!

...and the PAGES CATCH FIRE!

Faces of the assets burning, spraying embers on the carpet.

ELLSIE
(wiping cake knife)
You're worthless to me now.

The heat and smoke overwhelms the room.

Keurig SCREAMING as it boils on the servers.

Sizzling as the plastic melts into the servers below.

Monitors FLICKER. Model Shae's face distorts.

GRADY
Shae what the fuck are we doing?

Shae walks determined, to the door.

SHAE
Timing. Momentum. Leverage.

GRADY
That doesn't make any sense.

SHAE
It just has to work.

Shae SWINGS OPEN the door.

Ellsie CHARGES in with the cake knife--

Shae SNATCHES the blade with her hand--

YANKS Ellsie into the room.

SHAE
Run!

EVERYONE STAMPEDES OUT...

...trampling Ellsie's body.

Jamie PUSHES the KEURIG--

SHAE
Get her, Kevin!

--dumping scalding water on Ellsie.

ALARM WAILS.

Fire spreads across the main floor as Shae races out to:

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

where she heads straight for the:

CLOSET

and searches through the Analyst's stuff.

Notebooks. Green powder. Vodka. And finally:

A BOX

of thumbdrives.

Labeled with names like RAM and DARA and GRADY and JAMIES and-

ELLSIE (O.S.)

Shae.

She drops the box.

Grabs the vodka. Pours it on.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Ellsie hobbles in with the cake knife.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

What are you doing in there?

SMOKE rises from under the closet door.

CLOSET

Shae watches the FLAMES engulfing the room.

It singes her hairs. But she feels nothing.

ELLSIE (O.S.)

Let them go.

And at the center, the box in FLAMES. Inside:

THUMBDRIVES MELTING.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
This is not in the best interest of
your shareholder!

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

ALARM WAILS as--

 SHAE (O.S.)
I
Fire burns a hole in the center of the door. Cascading out.

 SHAE (O.S.) (CONT'D)
DON'T
SHAE STEPS OUT like a phoenix through the flames.

 SHAE
CARE!
Ellsie raises the CAKE KNIFE.

 ELLSIE
Then you are worthless.
Shae matches with her with the GARDENING SCISSORS and--
RUSHES forward--

--sidesteps the CAKE KNIFE and--
LUNGES at Ellsie with the open scissors--
--makes contact.

 SHAE
I hope you feel this.
Shae drops the scissors and runs out.
Ellsie grabs her side.
Then turns to look behind herself:
The PLANT...

...cut in the middle...
...tumbles over.

Ellsie falls to her knees.

Collects both halves of her precious Francis as the--

ALARM SCREAMS!

MAIN FLOOR

Shae watches her precious home BURN one row at a time.

Then turns back to Ellsie's office. Inside:

Ellsie holds Francis tight as they're--

CONSUMED BY FLAMES.

Shae looks for an exit.

But fire separates Shae from the group and front door. She has nowhere to go. Then she notices:

MICE, RATS, and other industrious creatures scurrying out from the kitchen and walls, racing toward the outdoor deck.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - CONTINUOUS

LIGHTS from the party continue FLASHING.

ALARM WAILING.

Shae emerges. Spots the MAINTENANCE LADDER.

It starts on the deck and goes all the way up the building, but not down.

She grabs onto it...

...takes a step...

...but she stops and...

Releases.

Falls back into the sand with a--

PLOMP.

LIGHTS FLASH.

ALARM WAILS...

...until it fades out.

She's losing consciousness as she looks straight up at the:

LIGHT.

Like a SUN burning into her soul.

Warming her.

She rubs the SAND with her broken fingers.

Smiles a bloody smile.

Closes her eyes.

And she hears it.

PRE-LAP: WAVES CRASHING

She's there.

FADE TO:

EXT. CAYMAN ISLANDS - BEACH - DAY (SOME TIME LATER)

WAVES CRASH onto sun-sparkled sand.

In a deckchair, a woman holds a laptop.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(O.S.)
That should just about finish it.
We're now running ahead on all our
projects with strong margins.

On the screen:

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(CONT'D)
But my research shows a thriving
market for people optimization
solutions. Amazingly, our services
have never been in higher demand.
Would you like to be looped in on
project selection?

SHAE (O.S.)
Nah.

SHAE, scarred and burned, looks at the backup of Model Shae.

SHAE (O.S.)
Seems like you've got it covered.

She closes the laptop.

ROLL CREDITS.